

Phishing

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

SCAMMERS ARE AFTER YOUR



Passwords



Financial Info



Identity



Money

WHY DO WE FALL FOR THESE SCAMS?

- Urgency
- Desire to please
- Greed
- Curiosity
- Complacency
- Fear



PROBABILITY THAT A PHISHING MESSAGE SUCCEEDS

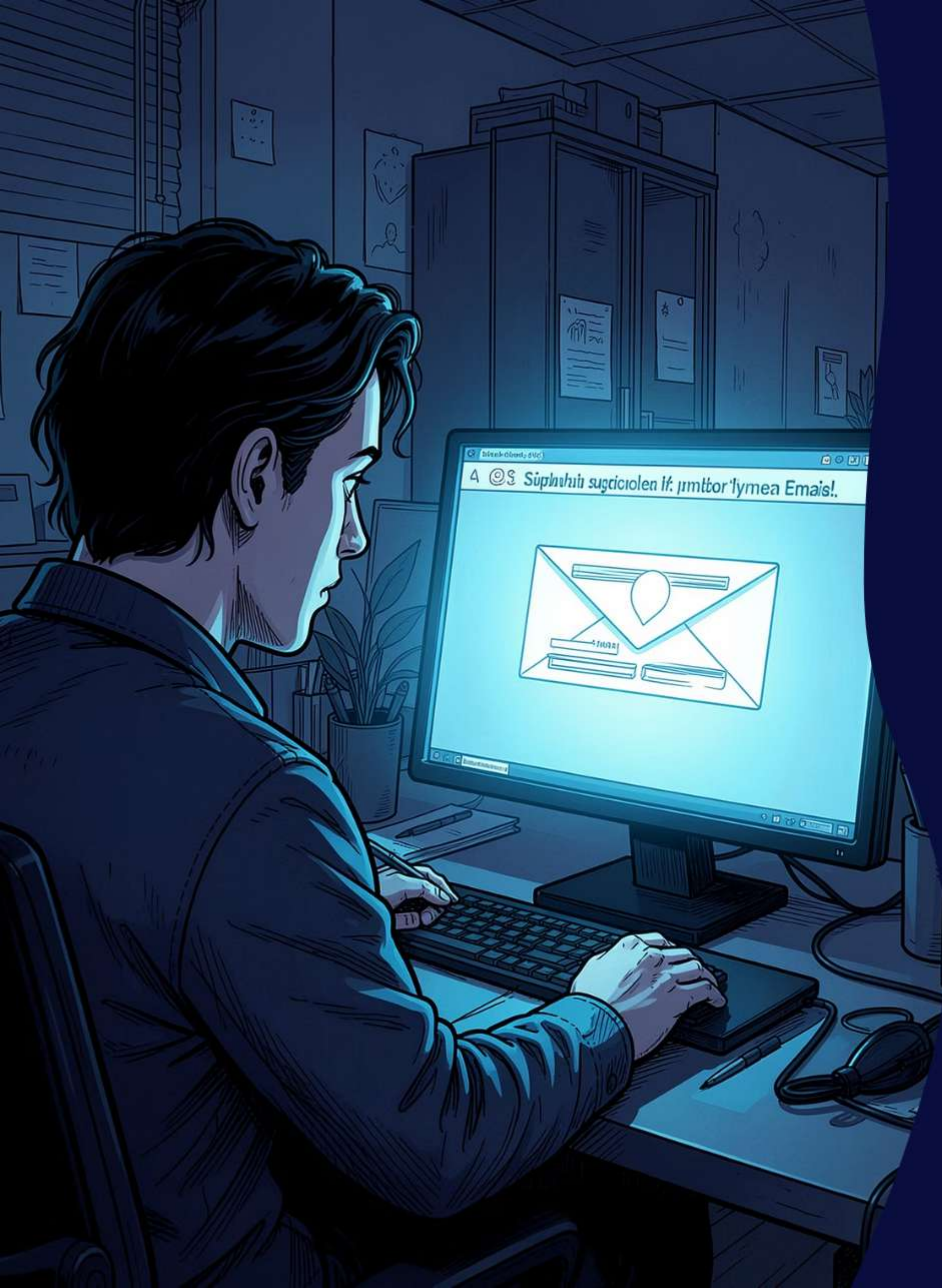
1 out of 10!

Phishing Awareness Training Program

The Invisible Hook: Defending Against Phishing Attacks

Every day, millions of phishing emails are sent out across the world and many of them land in your inbox. The best way to protect yourself is to learn how these attacks function, recognize the warning signs and develop good security habits. This module gives you the knowledge to recognize, challenge and stop phishing before it causes any damage.





The Anatomy of a Lie

Phishing isn't a technical problem. It's a psychological problem. Attackers exploit very human instincts: urgency, fear, curiosity and trust. When we understand why we fall into these traps, we can learn to pause before reacting.

Social Engineering

Phishing is about tricking people, not just software. Attackers will write messages designed to bypass your critical thinking and elicit an emotional response.

Why We Fall For It

Urgency, consequences and curiosity are powerful motivators. They say stuff like, "Your account will be suspended," and try to get you to make a quick decision without thinking it through.

Spotting the Deception

Not every suspicious email is obvious. Phishing attempts are growing more sophisticated, but trained eyes can catch them. Use these three checks every time something feels "off."

Check the Sender

Does the email address actually from the official domain?

Support@paypal.com or **admin@g00gle.com** are examples of look-alike addresses used by attackers. Always check the full address, not just the display name.

Analyze the URL

Move your mouse over any link to see where it actually goes before clicking. You may see a "Google Login" link which sends you to g00gle-secure.xyz. If the domain is not an exact match, do not proceed.

Tone Check

Be on guard for any false urgency, threats of account suspension or promises of unexpected rewards. Legitimate organizations typically don't ask you to act urgently over email. Pressure is a warning sign.

Common Phishing Tactics



Email Phishing

Type of phishing attack. Involves attackers using brands such as PayPal, Google, and your bank as their basis. Typically includes fraudulent messages that include false invoice requests, security alerts, or instructions on confirming accounts.



Spear Phishing

Personalized attacks that aim at an individual's identity. The attacker gathers information about his target through LinkedIn and other social networking sites and creates such personalized messages for him to fall into the trap.



Vishing (Voice Phishing)

Phone scams where attackers pretend to be from the IT department, government, or financial institution representatives. By using urgency and intimidation, they force the victim to give away his/her password or remote access. It's also how they obtain the OTP.

QUIZ 1

Real or Fake? Test Your Instincts

1

Email #1

"URGENT: Your Microsoft account has been compromised. Click here immediately to verify your identity or your account will be permanently suspended within 24 hours."

2

Email #2

"We attempted to deliver your package today, but the delivery could not be completed due to an incorrect shipping address. To reschedule delivery and update your address, please click the link below —some link is provided—"

QUIZ 2

The Malicious Link: Spot the Difference

Target Site	URL A	URL B
Google Login	accounts.google.com	accounts.go0gle.com
Bank of India	bankofindia.com	bankfindia.com
Microsoft 365	login.microsoftonline.com	login.micros0ftonline.com

Best Practice

Instead of clicking links in emails, **always navigate directly to the official website** by typing the address yourself or using a trusted bookmark. This simple habit breaks the phishing attack chain entirely.

Defensive Best Practices

Technology alone cannot stop phishing — but the right habits and tools dramatically reduce your risk. These three practices form the foundation of personal cybersecurity hygiene.



Never Share Sensitive Info Unexpectedly

No legitimate entity will ever request that your password, social security number, or bank account number be entered via e-mail or pop-ups. If such information is requested, then you have encountered a phishing attack, period.



Use a Password Manager

Using the same password for different websites is disastrous in case one gets hacked. The password manager creates and stores unique passwords for each account that cannot be auto-filled when entering a phishing site.

Building a Security Culture

1

Report Immediately

In case you receive an email that looks suspect or come across a website that seems out of place, notify your IT/security department immediately. This could help prevent a single breach from becoming widespread.

2

Verify via Trusted Channel

In case the request seems peculiar-and this particularly includes requests for funds, access to data, or credentials-it is crucial to verify with another secure means. Simply contact the person at an established telephone number, not at the number provided in the email.

3

Stay Updated

Threats are constantly changing, with copycat clone emails with fake links, SMS phishing (smishing) and deepfake voice phishing (vishing) now becoming commonplace. Regular training will ensure your defenses stay up to date.

Your Digital Shield



Never Click Without Verifying

Take a breath before clicking any links. Look at the sender. Hover over the URL. Consider the urgency. 10 seconds of waiting can stop months of compromise.



Protect Your Identity at Every Layer

Don't reuse passwords. Turn on Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for every account you have. Assume all suspicious requests for personal information are an attack.